NDA: 36 | INDIA 43 | *Rest others



SUMIT KUMAR

FIGHTBACK Akhilesh Yadav at a poll rally in Kannauj, May 10

AKHILESH PUTS YOGI ON THE MAT

The Congress-SP alliance in Uttar Pradesh has done the unimaginable—turned the tide against the BJP by halving its Lok Sabha tally and endangering its prospects in the next state election

By **Prashant Srivastava**

"***UP ne kamaal kar diya*** (UP did an incredible thing)...." That was Congress leader Rahul Gandhi when asked about the Lok Sabha result in Uttar Pradesh. It is, in fact, the "*UP ke ladke*", as Rahul and Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav are fondly called in UP, who have managed to do the 'incredible', stun the BJP despite the Ram temple and the Modi-Yogi double engine hype.

The Congress-SP alliance won 43 of UP's 80 Lok Sabha seats (SP 37 and Congress six), restricting the BJP-led NDA to just 36 seats in the state, a feat that has huge ramifications. UP had propelled Narendra Modi's rise to power in 2014, sending 71 BJP MPs to the Lok Sabha; in 2019, it helped